

TEACHING TIPS:

- This song is a great introduction to singing in harmony.
- The different verses have some big **vocal jumps** in the melody. Make sure voices are warmed up properly to help sing these leaps cleanly. Begin by making a siren sound, going up high and down low. This will help warm up the vocal cords. Then, try using a warm-up like *Ear Warm* from *Sing Warm-ups*.
- As an introduction to pitching **intervals**, sing up a scale using the numbers 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8, then back down 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1. Then try an arpeggio 1 3 5 3 1. Then try other permutations e.g. 1 2 1 3 1 4 1 5 1 6 1 7 1 8.

WHAT YOU NEED



Pieces of paper labelled with letter names of a C major scale; keyboards (notes C-C with stickers on) or pitched percussion (notes C-C)

BRIGHT IDEA



Can the children think of and **identify any intervals** outside of the classroom, for example a door bell, a cuckoo, a mobile phone ringtone, the first four notes of the Star Wars Theme, the call 'yoo hoo'? **Musical intervals are all around us!**

PITCH



How high or low a note sits
Interval – the difference in pitch between two sounds

Scale – an arrangement of notes in ascending or descending order of pitch

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES
7 - 11



Musical Ladders!

The melody of this song has some big leaps in it. The musical distance (leap) from one note to another is called an **interval**. Try this activity to practise counting intervals and playing them to **see what they sound like**.

Place eight pieces of paper in a vertical line on the floor and label them: C D E F G A B C. This is your 'musical ladder' or **scale**. Ask two volunteers to stand on two of the 'notes'. Count and sing up the steps between the two notes to find the musical interval. Remember to include the start and end notes in your count (e.g. D-A would be a **fifth**, and E-F would be a **second**).

When you have identified the interval, ask the class to play it using keyboards or pitched percussion instruments such as glockenspiels, xylophones or chime bars. Can they try singing the intervals, with one person singing the bottom note and the other singing the top one?

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?



To hear the difference between musical intervals.

To identify, play and sing musical intervals.